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Course: IT FDN 130 GP – Foundations of Databases & SQL Programming

Assignment 06 - SQL Views, Functions, and Stored Procedures

Introduction

In this article we'll be discussing the SQL View statement, along with the similarities and differences between a view, function, and stored procedure.

SQL Views, Functions, and Stored Procedures

I. When would you use an SQL View?

An SQL View is useful in several ways, including for security, data abstraction, and reporting.. It provides a way to limit access to the data by granting users access to only the view created. For abstraction and reporting purposes, a view can save and hide complex code, allowing a user to run the created view using only a select statement, rather than having to run through the more complex SQL syntax. Visually splitting or partitioning data is also possible with a view, allowing a user to divide the data by rows or columns.¹

II. What are some of the differences and similarities between a View, Function, and Stored Procedure?

A function, view, and stored procedure are all a named set of SQL statements. Each can be set up by using the Create command followed by the applicable feature - 'Create View', 'Create Function', 'Create Procedure.' A user can then use just a Select or Execute statement to evaluate or run an otherwise more complex set of code.² Additionally, all three are a way of saving code into the database itself, rather than on the hard drive.³

Some differences are that a function can call an individual value - whether it be a specific integer, word, date, etc.⁴ Functions can also use parameters to change the results of the query. Though views can be changed by using the 'Where' clause.⁵ Procedures are much more flexible in that they can have different kinds of statements included as part of its syntax other than select. For example, they can include inserts, updates, deletes, etc.and are used for more complex reporting.⁶ Views, as described in more detail in I. above, return a virtual table, consisting of columns and rows.

Summary

The article discussed the SQL View statement, along with the similarities and differences between a view, function, and stored procedure.

References:

1-Module06Notes pgs. 1, 5-7

2-Module06Notes pgs. 15

3- Creating Views Functions and Stored Procedures Part 1 (YouTube video)

4- Creating Views Functions and Stored Procedures Part 3 (YouTube video)

5-Module06Notes pgs. 12

6- Creating Views Functions and Stored Procedures Part 4 (YouTube video)